# SOLOMON BARINE AKPURU

*Senior Full-Stack Software Engineer*

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## PROFILE

Full-stack engineer with 5+ years architecting and shipping scalable SaaS, fintech, and real-time systems serving thousands of concurrent users. My experience cuts across Elixir/Phoenix, Ruby on Rails, Laravel, and the modern React/TypeScript ecosystem, with deep experience in payment infrastructure (Stripe, Flutterwave, Paystack, NowPayments) and event-driven architectures (Kafka, Phoenix Channels, Redis Pub/Sub). Track record of owning systems end-to-end — from architecture decisions and database design through CI/CD, observability, and production reliability. Comfortable operating asynchronously across US and EU time zones.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Elixir, Ruby, PHP

**Frontend:** React, Next.js, Nuxt.js, Redux Toolkit, TailwindCSS, Material UI

**Backend:** Elixir Phoenix, Ruby on Rails, Laravel

**Databases:** PostgreSQL (advanced), Redis, MongoDB, MySQL

**Real-Time & Messaging:** WebSockets, Phoenix Channels, Kafka, Redis Pub/Sub, Sidekiq

**Payments & Integrations:** Stripe, Flutterwave, Paystack, NowPayments, VTpass

**Cloud & DevOps:** AWS, Docker, GitHub Actions, Nginx, Fly.io, Hostinger

**Observability & Quality:** Prometheus, RSpec, structured logging, CI/CD pipelines

**Architecture:** REST API design, event-driven systems, microservices, caching strategies, system design

**Practices:** Agile, async-first collaboration, code review, mentorship, technical writing

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Senior Software Engineer (Freelance Consulting)** — *Independent* Jan 2023 – Present

- **Property rental SaaS —** Delivered a multi-tenant platform serving 2,000+ landlords and tenants. Cut query latency by ~80% through composite indexing, query plan analysis, and a Redis-backed read cache for hot listings.
- **Crypto–fiat exchange infrastructure —** Built ledger, settlement, and reconciliation services processing $30K+ in monthly transaction volume across 5+ assets. Implemented rule-based fraud signals and idempotent payment flows that materially reduced chargebacks and double-spend risk.
- **Digital art e-commerce platform —** Architected Stripe-integrated checkout with webhook-driven reconciliation, achieving 99.95% transaction success rate. Designed the order state machine to handle retries, partial failures, and refunds without operator intervention.
- **Recommendation engine —** Shipped a collaborative-filtering recommender over 8,000+ user interactions that lifted session engagement by 32%. Owned the data model, scoring pipeline, and cold-start fallback.
- **Acted as technical lead** across engagements: scoping requirements, writing API specs, reviewing PRs, and onboarding contractors into existing codebases.

***Stack:*** *Laravel, Ruby on Rails, Next.js, Nuxt.js, React, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Stripe, Flutterwave, Paystack, NowPayments*

**Senior Web Developer (Contract)** — *Digital Factory* May 2024 – Jan 2025

- Improved Largest Contentful Paint by ~20% and reduced page load times by 24% via render-path profiling, asset preloading, image optimization, and server-side rendering tuning.
- Led migration from Paperclip to Active Storage across the production codebase, eliminating a long-standing upgrade blocker and unlocking a Rails major-version bump.

- Refactored legacy controllers and views into modular service objects and reusable view components; introduced an RSpec coverage baseline and integrated GitHub Actions CI/CD, raising deployment confidence and shortening release cycles.
- Partnered cross-functionally with designers and backend engineers on API contracts and design-system consistency.

***Stack:*** *Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, RSpec, AWS, Nginx, PostgreSQL, SCSS, GitHub Actions*

**Software Engineer II** — *Syntrix Technologies* May 2021 – Apr 2023

- Designed and shipped features across a Django + React stack and a parallel Rails service, owning the full lifecycle from technical spec through deployment and post-release monitoring.
- Containerized services with Docker and built GitHub Actions pipelines for test, build, and deploy — reducing release cycle time and removing manual deployment steps.
- Integrated Kafka for asynchronous event processing across services and instrumented Prometheus metrics with alerting on key business and infrastructure SLIs.
- Drove WCAG accessibility compliance by introducing semantic HTML, ARIA patterns, and contrast audits into the component library.

***Stack:*** *Python, Django, Ruby on Rails, Node.js, React, TailwindCSS, Docker, GitHub Actions, MySQL, Kafka, Prometheus*

**Software Engineer I** — *Syntrix Technologies* Jul 2020 – May 2021

- Implemented secure authentication and OAuth integrations; offloaded message delivery, notifications, and scheduled jobs to Sidekiq, reducing user-perceived latency on critical paths.
- Tuned PostgreSQL queries and introduced a Redis caching layer, cutting p95 response times on hot endpoints.
- Built reusable Next.js + Material UI components to standardize UI patterns and accelerate feature delivery.

***Stack:*** *Ruby on Rails, Next.js, Material UI, PostgreSQL, Redis, Sidekiq, WebSockets, OAuth*

## SELECTED PROJECTS

**Toucan** — *Real-Time Social Platform* Oct 2024 – Present

- Real-time social platform built on Phoenix Channels and WebSockets, supporting messaging, posts, likes, threaded comments, groups with role-based moderation, and presence tracking.

***Stack:*** *Elixir Phoenix, React, TypeScript, TailwindCSS, PostgreSQL, Fly.io*

**RechargePadi** — *Bills Payment Gateway* 2025

- Production bills payment gateway for airtime, data, electricity, and cable across Nigerian providers. Integrated VTpass for service provisioning and Paystack for collections, with idempotent reconciliation and automated failure recovery.

***Stack:*** *Nuxt.js, Ruby on Rails, VTpass API, Paystack, PostgreSQL*

**Minerva** — *ML-Powered Predictive Maintenance* In progress

- Building a predictive-maintenance platform that ingests sensor telemetry and applies anomaly detection to forecast equipment failures. Designing the ingestion pipeline and model-serving boundary between the Phoenix application layer and Python ML services.

***Stack:*** *Elixir Phoenix, React, Python, PostgreSQL*

## OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

**OpenStack**

Authored a patch preventing active replica state resets, mitigating a potential data-loss path.

Updated documentation to reflect the OpenStack CLI in place of the deprecated Manila CLI.

**Wikimedia**

Implemented dynamic page titles for SEO and navigation.
Added unit tests for JavaScript actions.
Fixed early 'average views' update timing for article view counts.

## EDUCATION

**B.Eng, Petroleum and Gas Engineering** — *University of Port Harcourt* 2016 – 2021

**Software Development Program** — *Microverse*